smile, that will inspire Indian mothers and they will aspire that their children should also become Bhagat Singh. Thus the number of persons ready to sacrifice their lives for the freedom of our country will increase enormously'. Yet, he was human, and being human pricked his conscience. Of desires that remained unfulfilled. Of what could have been had he lived. With these thoughts in mind, he ended his note sorrowfully with the words:

> Yet, one thing pricks me even today. My heart nurtured some ambitions for doing something for humanity and for my country. I have not been able to fulfil even one-thousandth part of these ambitions. If I live I might perhaps get a chance to fulfil them. If ever it came to my mind that I should die, it came from this end only.[7]

There is a sense of desolation here as one begins to fathom the feelings of a young man who knows he will die within twenty-four hours. The sense of loss of a life which could have been lived in any normal circumstance is enough to make one weep. The wretched and dismal end to a life brutally cut short is all too well understood by Bhagat Singh himself as he pens his last words. Yet, he retains his dignity. His head remains high and unbowed even when as he comes to terms with his own mortality. Almost a hundred years after India's Independence, Bhagat Singh's dream for India remains but a dream. The promise he held out remains unfulfilled. With opportunities for education, healthcare, racial, religious, and communal harmony all but squandered, as well as the threat of constant war, Independence lies barren and burnt-out.

Modern day independent India's leaders do not understand what the revolutionaries understood only too well—the need for sacrifice for a better India. Bhagat Singh remained acutely aware of this right to the very end. If sacrifice meant death, then so much the better. We can see this in Bhagat Singh's final letter written from Lahore Central Jail in November 1930 to B.K. Dutt, who had escaped the sentence of execution. The letter starkly displays his attitude to death. It was published in English originally in the now discontinued Calcutta weekly named *New Era*. Bhagat Singh begins by saying, 'The judgment has been delivered. I am condemned to death.' He then adds that '[i]n these cells, besides myself, there are many other